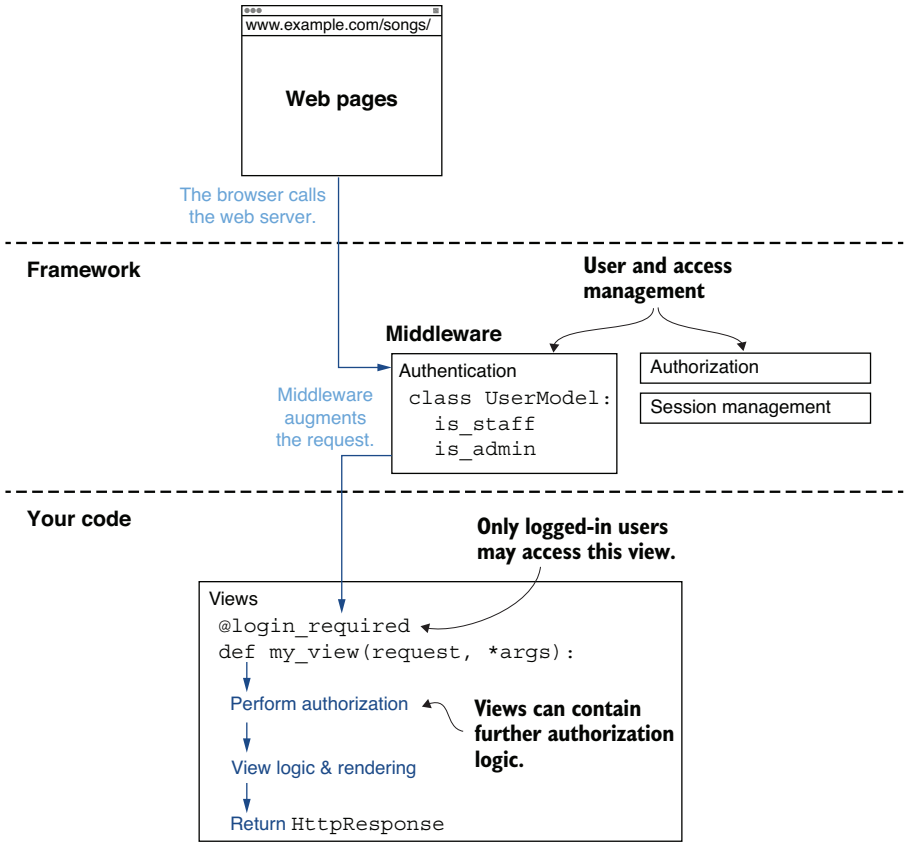


Figure 6.1 Session management and login control through middleware

6.2 Storing user data

In the previous chapter, you used the `createsuperuser` command to create an admin account to access the Django Admin. On the Django Admin home page, there is a listing of ORM objects registered with the site—one of which being the `User` object. Each user account in the system is represented by an entry in the database proxied by a `django.contrib.auth.models.User` object. The `User` object stores a username and password in the database. All of this is an oversimplification (read: lie); Django's user management system is quite flexible and allows you to customize heavily, but for the time being, the mental model of a plain `User` object is easier to consider.

6.2.1 Choosing a user account mechanism

Most of the time, you want to associate data with a user account. Consider a musician's account; you already have a `Musician` ORM object, and now, it would be nice